Philosophy — Can It Really Become Engineering?

— The Challenge of Building Civil Society Control Engineering (CSCE) —

Kushi Susumu

CSCE Evaluation Manual Ver1.0 — Release Notes

A Research Record of Case001–Case010

Table of Contents

Preface

Philosophy — Can It Really Become Engineering?

— The Challenge of Building Civil Society Control Engineering (CSCE) —

This is not a book that declares a new field of learning complete.

Nor is it a memoir of my own life.

It is the record of one student of law who encountered a single theory, and who kept questioning that theory for forty-five years.

And it is the record of everything that led, at the far end of that questioning, to a new problem: can philosophy really become engineering?

In graduate school, I encountered the work of a single mentor — a theory so distinctive that, at the time, it was called heterodox within the academic community. But I gave up my dream of becoming a scholar, and spent the next forty-five years living apart from that theory. It was only after retirement, when I encountered AI, that I returned to my mentor's writings and, after forty-five years, finally came to understand their essence. That understanding can be put in one sentence: to move beyond feudalism, to live within modernity, and to aim toward civil society.

How I came to this encounter, why I gave up on becoming a scholar, and how — forty-five years later — my understanding deepened through dialogue with AI: all of this I tell in detail in Chapters 1 through 4.

But here a new question arose. Are we truly moving in the direction our ideals point toward? Is education? Are corporations? Is government? Is AI? Is there any way — one that anyone could reproduce — to confirm whether our ideals and our reality actually match?

Out of this question came

Civil Society Control Engineering (CSCE).

CSCE is not a completed field of learning.

Even now, I keep pursuing the question:

“Philosophy — can it really become engineering?”

This book does not claim to answer that question.

It is a starting point — for readers and me to think through this question together, to test it, and to carry it forward.

If, after finishing this book, a new question has taken root in you, that will be the greatest joy I could ask for.

Chapter 1 — An Encounter with a Heterodox Theory

— The Origin of My Life as a Researcher —

The origin of my life as a researcher lies in my decision to enter the graduate program in private law at Toyo University's Graduate School of Law.

Having studied law as an undergraduate, I went on to graduate school because I wanted to study civil law more deeply.

At the time, I thought of legal studies as the discipline of learning statutes, learning case law, and correctly interpreting the law.

That is, of course, important work within legal studies.

But the legal studies I encountered in graduate school were something entirely different from what I had imagined.

That encounter was Professor Numa Seiya's seminar.

A Seminar for Learning About Human Beings, Not the Law

The first thing that surprised me on joining Professor Numa's seminar was that it was not a seminar where we read only law books.

Every week, the assigned reading was a work of philosophy, of thought, of literature.

Locke.

Rousseau.

Marx.

Kropotkin.

Mao Zedong.

Kafka.

Natsume Sōseki.

Ōsugi Sakae.

And the writings of many other thinkers and philosophers.

We read, formed our own thoughts, presented them, and argued.

There was no “correct answer.”

What was demanded of us was to hold a view of our own and to explain it logically.

At the time, I found myself puzzled:

“Why are we reading philosophy and literature in a seminar on civil law?”

But looking back now, what Professor Numa was trying to cultivate in us was not knowledge of the law.

The capacity to think about society.

And

the capacity to think about the human being.

What I Learned from Professor Numa

There is more than I can count that I learned in graduate school.

Independence.

Equality.

Freedom.

Coercion that gives. Coercion that takes away.

The best and the second-best.

The principle of the ideal. The principle of practice. The principle of operation.

These were not separate pieces of knowledge.

They were ways of seeing — for observing society, for thinking about society.

And at their center was a way of understanding the entire Civil Code as a single system of thought.

The Civil Code Is a Code Built Around the Human Being

Professor Numa never explained the Civil Code as a mere collection of separate statutes.
He understood the entire Civil Code as a single, coherent system.
Property law, he taught, is
the law that governs the economic activity of human beings possessed of free will.
Family law, on the other hand, is
the law that protects and supplements those who cannot yet fully exercise their free will.
And the Civil Code is what constitutes both of these together, as a single system.
I was profoundly struck by this explanation.
Until then I had learned contract law, property law, family law, and inheritance law each as separate subjects.
But Professor Numa taught me that
the entire Civil Code is built upon a single idea — the question of what a human being is.
This way of thinking became the starting point of my life as a researcher.

A Heterodox Theory

At the time, Professor Numa's theory was known within civil-law scholarship as "the Numa Theory."
But it was not the mainstream theory.
Rather — at least within the academic community I encountered at the time — it was received, as an independent theory attempting to understand the entire Civil Code as a single system of thought, as something heterodox.
The Numa Theory was not simply an accumulation of interpretations of individual provisions.
It was a theory that tried to understand the Civil Code as a whole system.
Precisely for that reason, it held a different perspective from conventional legal interpretation.
So those of us who studied in Professor Numa's seminar were sometimes seen as
"students from that unusual seminar" —
"heretics."
I felt that atmosphere myself, as a student.
But strangely, I never found it unpleasant.
If anything, I felt as though
I was being shown a world that no one else was looking at.

I Had No Talent for Scholarship

Graduate school was full of stimulation.
But at the same time, I came to know my own limits.
Whenever I presented in the seminar, Professor Numa's criticism was severe.
I thought I had reasoned it through myself, but I hadn't reached the essence.
I couldn't keep up with the discussion.
Little by little, I came to a realization:
I have no talent as a scholar.
Accepting this was very painful.
When I entered graduate school, I had imagined a life as a researcher.
But I gave up that dream.
Having advanced to the doctoral program, I needed to acquire a new skill to support myself.
My older brother worked as a programmer, and it was from him that I learned the basics of programming.
After that I taught myself, and eventually made my living in systems development.
And so I began walking a path apart from legal studies.

But the Question Remained

Even after leaving graduate school, one thing stayed lodged in my heart.
“What is a human being?”
“What is society?”

The volumes of Professor Numa's collected works, which I had bought as a graduate student, stayed on my bookshelf.

For forty-five years, I never opened them once.

But I never once got rid of them, either.

Looking back now, I realize that, within me, the research had never ended.

It had simply been sleeping, quietly, for a long time.

At the End of This Chapter

In graduate school, I encountered a single heterodox theory.

And without fully understanding it, I gave up my dream of becoming a scholar and moved into the entirely different world of systems development.

But the question I learned in graduate school never disappeared.

It remained quietly within me for forty-five years.

Then, when I reached retirement and encountered AI, that question began to stir again.

It was only then that I first realized:

The research I had thought was finished in graduate school had never actually ended.
For forty-five years, it had simply been waiting for the moment it would ripen within me.

Chapter 2 — Forty-Five Years Later, the Research Began Again

— The Last Challenge of My Life —

In Professor Numa Seiya's seminar, I learned a great many things.
But at the same time, I came to feel keenly that I had no talent as a scholar.
I could not adequately answer Professor Numa's questions.
I could not organize my own thinking into scholarship.
I gave up the path of living as a scholar.
Having advanced to the doctoral program, I chose a new path in order to make a living.
My brother worked as a programmer, and it was from him that I learned the basics of programming; after that I taught myself and went to work in the world of systems development.
In this way, my life turned sharply, from legal studies toward the world of information systems.

A Collection of Writings, Sleeping on the Shelf

Professor Numa's collected works, bought in my graduate-student days, stayed lined up on my bookshelf.
I never got rid of them.
But for forty-five years, I never opened them, either.
Every day was consumed by work.
I poured everything I had into learning new technologies, designing systems, and solving problems for the people who used them.
I believed that the research of my graduate-school years had, within me, already come to an end.
And yet I could not part with the books.
Looking back now, I think that somewhere in my heart, the thought remained:
“Someday, I want to take up that learning again.”

Retirement, and a Turning Point

When I reached retirement, I returned to Okinawa.
The life that had revolved around work came to an end, and I began to think about how to live the years ahead.
It was then that my son said to me:
“Dad, you're not someone who ends at retirement.”
“You're someone who finds purpose, finds meaning, and takes on new challenges.”
And then:
“Why don't you try using ChatGPT?”
And:
“Why don't you set yourself the goal of publishing a hundred books?”
he suggested.

A Hundred Books: My Life's Last Research Plan

Hearing these words, I thought it over.
There was no special meaning in the number one hundred itself.
What truly mattered to me was
finishing, at the end of my life, the research I had left unfinished in graduate school.
I could not become a scholar.
I could not fully understand the Numa Theory.
That fact had stayed with me the whole time.
So I decided:
I would make publishing a hundred books into a research plan.

I would organize everything I had learned in graduate school, from the beginning.
I would study the Numa Theory once more.
I would write it all down, in my own words.
If that accumulation came to a hundred volumes, that would be enough.
For me, publishing a hundred books was never about competing on the count.
It was the goal that would let me finally complete the research I had left undone for forty-five years.

An Encounter with AI

At my son's suggestion, I began conversations with ChatGPT.
At first, it was little more than a willingness to try a new technology.
But dialogue with AI turned out to be different from what I had expected.
It was not a tool that simply gave me answers.
When I explained my thinking, it asked back:
“Why do you think that?”
“What is your basis for that?”
To answer those questions, I took Professor Numa's collected works down from the shelf for the first time in forty-five years.
Passages I could not understand as a student, I could now understand.
Forty-five years of thinking things through on the job, in systems development, had — without my realizing it — become the foundation for finally understanding Professor Numa's thought.

I Had Only Meant to Write Down Memories

At first, I had not intended to write a research book.
Memories of Professor Numa.
Memories of my graduate-school days.
What I had learned in Professor Numa's seminar.
Those were the things I meant to set down.
But as I kept writing, something gradually shifted.
What had begun as writing down memories had, before I knew it, become
re-learning the Numa Theory itself.
Every book I wrote raised a new question.
To sort out that question, I wrote another book.
It was a continuous cycle.

An Unexpected Discovery

As I continued my dialogue with AI, reread Professor Numa's writings, and kept writing e-books, I came to realize one thing.
The Numa Theory is not merely a heterodox theory of civil law.
It is a way of thinking that understands the entire Civil Code as a system, and that looks further, toward society as a whole.
When I organized its essence in my own terms, I arrived at a single phrase:
“To move beyond feudalism, to live within modernity, and to aim toward civil society.”
This sentence does not appear in Professor Numa's own writings.
It is my own summation — the fruit of forty-five years of studying the Numa Theory, which tried to systematize the whole Civil Code even while being called heretical.

A New Challenge

I began this research in order to relearn the Numa Theory.
But as the research continued, a new question arose.

I could understand the ideal.

I could understand the thought.

But

there was no way to evaluate whether that ideal was being realized in actual society.

That is what I came to notice.

From here my research took an unexpected turn — from understanding the Numa Theory to

a new challenge: Civil Society Control Engineering (CSCE).

That was not the goal I had set out toward from the beginning.

It was a new research problem I arrived at naturally, as a result of carrying on the research I had left unfinished in graduate school.

Chapter 3 — What Forty-Five Years of Studying the Numa Theory Showed Me

— An Understanding: “Beyond Feudalism, Within Modernity, Toward Civil Society” —

Rereading Professor Numa's writings for the first time in forty-five years, and continuing my research through dialogue with AI, I kept turning one question over in my mind.

What, in the end, was the Numa Theory aiming at?

Understanding the Civil Code as a system.

Thinking with the human being at the center.

The principle of the ideal, the principle of practice, the principle of operation.

Independence, equality, freedom.

Each of these is an important idea in its own right.

But taken alone, none of them showed me the whole picture.

I read the collected works over and over, and reorganized them in my own words.

Then a single current came into view.

What Is Feudalism?

The first thing I considered was what “feudalism” means.

In a feudal society, a person's way of life is determined by the status and lineage into which they are born.

Whose child one was born as.

Which house one belongs to.

Whom one obeys.

These things govern a person's life.

There, a human being is not treated as one independent person, but positioned as part of a status or a community.

Rereading Professor Numa's writings, I came to think:

Isn't the Civil Code a code meant to liberate human beings from a society like that?

What Is Modernity?

Then what is modernity, the stage beyond feudalism?

As I came to understand it, modernity is

a society that recognizes each individual human being as an independent Subject.

That is why, under the Civil Code, entering into contracts, holding property, and deciding things by one's own will are all taken as given.

And yet, at the same time,

young children and those without sufficient capacity to judge cannot be treated in exactly the same way.

So the Civil Code establishes institutions such as parental authority and adult guardianship, protecting and supplementing those who cannot yet fully exercise their free will.

In other words, the Civil Code is

a code that constitutes freedom and protection together, as a single system.

I came to think that this is one of the great distinguishing features of the Numa Theory.

What Is Civil Society?

Then what is civil society, the stage that lies beyond?

For a long time, I searched for the answer.

And after forty-five years of continued study, I arrived at one understanding.

To move beyond feudalism, to live within modernity, and to aim toward civil society.

This phrase does not simply reject feudal society.

Nor does it reject modern society.
Move beyond feudal society;
cherish the achievements modern society has built — the rule of law, human rights, popular sovereignty;
and aim further, toward a society centered on human dignity.
Isn't that civil society?
This is the understanding I came to hold.

This Is My Own Understanding

Here there is one thing I want to say to my readers.
"To move beyond feudalism, to live within modernity, and to aim toward civil society."
This sentence does not appear anywhere in Professor Numa's writings.
It is my own summation of the Numa Theory as a whole — arrived at through forty-five years of continued study, and through continued thought in dialogue with AI.
So I do not mean to claim that this understanding is the only correct one.
It is entirely possible that a reader, reading the collected works, would arrive at a different understanding.
That would be entirely natural, as scholarship.
I hope that such a discussion will arise.

A New Question

But once I had arrived at this understanding, a new question arose.
"To move beyond feudalism, to live within modernity, and to aim toward civil society."
As an ideal, I can understand this.
But
is today's society really moving in that direction?
What about corporations?
What about schools?
What about government?
And what about AI?
It is possible to speak of ideals.
But
there is no way to confirm whether the ideal and the reality actually match.
Here I encountered a question I had never even considered in graduate school.
Can philosophy be evaluated?
And that question became the first step toward a new field of research: Civil Society Control Engineering (CSCE).

At the End of This Chapter

I began this research by relearning the Numa Theory.
But that research did not end with merely understanding the Numa Theory.
I wanted to build a way of comparing the ideal against reality, to confirm whether they match or where they diverge.
That desire grew larger and larger within me.
In the next chapter, I will tell the story of how, from that question, the idea of Civil Society Control Engineering (CSCE) was born.

Chapter 4 — Philosophy: Can It Really Become Engineering?

— The New Challenge Called CSCE —

Having studied the Numa Theory continuously for forty-five years, I arrived at one understanding:
“To move beyond feudalism, to live within modernity, and to aim toward civil society.”
I believe the essence of the Numa Theory lies in this phrase.
But once I reached that understanding, a new question arose.

Ideals Alone Do Not Change Society

Looking back through history, many thinkers have spoken of an ideal society.
Freedom.
Equality.
Human rights.
Democracy.
The rule of law.
Every one of these is an important ideal.
But does society change simply because we hold up an ideal?
I worked as a systems developer for forty-five years.
In systems development,
the ideal of “wanting to build a good system” alone does not complete a system.
Design it.
Implement it.
Verify that it works.
Evaluate it.
Improve it.
Only through this repeated cycle does something become an actual system.
From that experience, I began to wonder:
Isn't society exactly the same?

Can an Ideal Be Evaluated?

Here a question arose.
Take, for example, the ideal: “We aim to build a society that protects human dignity.”
This is a wonderful ideal.
But
is it really being protected?
What about in education?
What about in corporations?
What about in government?
What about in AI?
Many people speak of ideals.
But
there is almost no way to confirm whether the ideal and reality actually match.
I found this deeply unsettling.

What Systems Development Taught Me

In systems development, writing a specification is never called “completion.”

You actually run the system, and confirm that it behaves as designed.
If it differs from the design,
you investigate the cause,
and fix it.
This is simply taken for granted.
So what about social institutions?
What about the law?
What about education?
Who is confirming whether they operate according to their stated ideals?
And if the ideal and the reality diverge,
how is it to be improved?
I came to believe that a method was needed to answer this question.

The Difference Between Philosophy and Engineering

Here I considered the difference between philosophy and engineering.
Philosophy is the discipline of asking
“what ought we to aim for.”
Engineering, on the other hand, is the discipline of asking
“how do we realize it.”
I do not mean to say that one is superior to the other.
Both are necessary.
But
ideals alone do not move society.
Mechanisms alone cannot make human beings happy.
So I began to think:
Isn't a discipline needed that connects philosophy and engineering?

The Idea of Civil Society Control Engineering

I did not begin this research intending to turn the Numa Theory into engineering.
It was as a result of trying to understand the Numa Theory that I arrived at the conclusion that a method was needed to connect ideal and reality.
Out of the search for that method came the idea called
Civil Society Control Engineering (CSCE).
“Control,” here, does not mean dominating human beings.
Nor does it mean surveilling society.
It means finding the discrepancy between ideal and reality, and devising a mechanism for improving it.
In terms of systems development: confirm whether something operates according to specification, and improve it where necessary.
Could that way of thinking be applied to the evaluation of social institutions, education, corporations, and AI?
That was the starting point of CSCE.

CSCE Is Not a Completed Field of Learning

Here there is one thing I want to tell my readers.
I do not believe CSCE is a completed field of learning.
Rather, I am at the stage of putting a single question to society:
“Can philosophy really become engineering?”
This challenge may succeed.
It may fail.

That is not something I alone can decide.

Only through the examination, criticism, and improvement of many researchers and practitioners will it be decided whether this can stand as a field of learning in its own right.

Why I Wrote This Book

I did not write this book to say

"CSCE is complete."

I want to put a question to my readers.

Can philosophy really become engineering?

If an ideal can be evaluated by a method anyone can reproduce, society might be improved, little by little.

If it cannot,

then this challenge called CSCE has failed.

That answer has not yet been given.

That is precisely why I wrote this book.

At the End of This Chapter

In graduate school I encountered a heterodox theory.

I gave up my dream of becoming a scholar.

For forty-five years I worked in the world of systems development.

After retirement, an encounter with AI led me to take up research again.

And having relearned the Numa Theory, I arrived at a new question:

"A method for evaluating ideals is needed."

Out of that question was born Civil Society Control Engineering (CSCE).

This book is the record of that challenge.

And, at the same time, it is a question addressed to you, the reader:

Can philosophy really become engineering?

I hope that companions will come forward to think through that answer together with me.

Chapter 5 — How CSCE Was Born

— An Attempt to Turn Philosophy into Evaluation Engineering —

Civil Society Control Engineering (CSCE) is not a theory I hit upon suddenly, one day. Nor is it a theory AI created.

It was born when two experiences I had each carried for forty-five years — the Numa Theory, which I kept studying, and systems development, which I kept practicing — were joined into one, through dialogue with AI.

At First, I Did Not Even Have the Word "Evaluation"

When I began this research, all I had in mind was understanding the Numa Theory. Writing down memories. Rereading the collected works. Organizing my own thoughts. That was all.

But the more I wrote, the more new questions arose.

"I understand the ideal. But what about reality?"

A Point in Common with Systems Development

For forty-five years I was engaged in systems development. In systems development, the job does not end with writing a specification. You run it, confirm it works as designed, and fix it if there is a problem. In other words, there is a cycle:

Design. Implementation. Evaluation. Improvement.

I began to think:

Doesn't a social institution need this same cycle?

Civil Law Has an Ideal

Relearning the Numa Theory, I noticed something. The Civil Code has an ideal.

Freedom.

Equality.

Independence.

Human dignity.

But there is no way to confirm whether that ideal is actually being realized in society. The ideal is spoken of. Institutions are built. And yet

there exists no Evaluation Engineering to confirm whether the institution is operating according to the ideal.

This was the first time I noticed this.

Without Evaluation, There Can Be No Improvement

In systems development, what cannot be evaluated cannot be improved. If you don't know where the problem is, you cannot fix it.

Isn't society the same? “Let's make a better society.” “Let's protect human rights.” “Let's cherish democracy.” These ideals matter. But unless we can confirm

where the problem lies,

where it matches the ideal,

improvement is difficult.

The Idea of Evaluation Engineering

I do not want to deny ideals. On the contrary, I want to realize them. That is precisely why I came to believe a method was needed — one anyone could use with the same procedure — to compare ideal and reality and confirm whether they match or diverge. This is the idea called

CSCE Evaluation Engineering.

Evaluation Engineering is not a discipline for judging people. Nor is it a discipline for attacking institutions. It is

a discipline for observing the relationship between ideal and reality, discovering discrepancy, and connecting that discovery to improvement.

And Then, One Question Arose

Having begun to think about Evaluation Engineering, I encountered a still larger question:

“In the first place, by what standard should we evaluate?”

Freedom? Equality? Democracy? The rule of law? Human dignity? If the standard is ambiguous, the evaluation becomes ambiguous too.

I returned once again to the Numa Theory. And I found myself relearning not only the Civil Code, but philosophy, thought, history, and modern society itself, from the beginning. From there, my research advanced toward organizing a three-layer structure:

feudal society, modern society, civil society.

At the End of This Chapter

CSCE is not a discipline concerned only with the method of evaluation. It is also a discipline that

questions, again, the very standard by which we evaluate.

To answer this question, I attempted to organize society into three layers: feudal society, modern society, civil society.

In the next chapter, I will tell the story of why this three-layer structure became necessary, and how it came to connect to CSCE's evaluative standards.

Chapter 6 — Why a Three-Layer Structure Was Necessary

— In Search of a Ruler for Measuring Society —

Once I began thinking about CSCE Evaluation Engineering, I ran into one great wall.

What standard should we use to evaluate society?

Evaluation always requires a standard. School exams have grading criteria. Systems development has specifications. But when I tried to evaluate society, no such standard came into view.

For example, someone might say, “This institution is a good institution.” But unless we know what standard makes it “good,” we cannot actually evaluate it. I ran into this problem again and again.

What Counts as “Right” Differs from Person to Person

As I continued my dialogue with AI, thinking through various social problems, I noticed something strange.

For the very same event, different evaluators reached different conclusions.

One person says, “Freedom should come first.” Another says, “Equality should come first.” Yet another says, “Preserving order matters most.”

Each has their reasons. But left as they are, these arguments run parallel forever.

I began to think:

Rather than the conclusion, don't we need to sort out what kind of society each person is assuming as their premise?

Looking Back Through History

So I looked back through history. I relearned the Numa Theory. I reread philosophy. I reread the history of thought.

Then a single current came into view. Human society did not take its present form all at once. It changed over a long span of time. Organizing that change, I came to think it could be summarized into three images of society.

The First Layer: Feudal Society

In feudal society, a person's way of life is determined by the status and lineage into which they are born.

Those who rule and those who are ruled. Those who command and those who obey.

There, a human being is treated less as an individual Subject than as part of a community or a status system.

Of course, the actual feudal societies of history varied by region and era. What I call “feudal society” here is an evaluative model for understanding history.

The Second Layer: Modern Society

With modern society comes a great change. Each individual human being comes to be recognized as an independent person.

The rule of law. Fundamental human rights. Popular sovereignty. Freedom of contract. The prohibition of taking the law into one's own hands.

The Civil Code is the code that supports this modern society. And I believe this is also why the Numa Theory tried to understand the entire Civil Code as a single system.

The Third Layer: Civil Society

But is modern society the finished form? I did not think so.

Even where laws are in place, there are situations where human dignity is not sufficiently protected. Even where institutions exist, there are cases where freedom or equality is not, in reality, adequately guaranteed.

So I organized, as

civil society,

a society that takes modern society as its foundation while going further, placing the human being at its center.

Civil society, as I use the term here, is not a particular political ideology. It is a standard for evaluating society, one centered on human dignity.

The Three-Layer Structure Is Not for Ranking

Here is something I do not want misunderstood.

I am not trying to say, simply, that “feudal is bad” and “modern is good.”

Actual society is an overlap of all three layers. One institution has modern elements. Another still carries feudal elements. And there is also movement toward civil society.

So CSCE does not evaluate society in black and white. Evaluation begins by

observing which layer's characteristics are showing through.

A First Step Toward Evaluation Engineering

By organizing this three-layer structure, I finally began to see a standard for evaluation.

Social institutions. Education. Corporations. Government. AI.

If we observe these from the three perspectives of

feudal society, modern society, and civil society,

could we organize the relationship between ideal and reality? That is what I came to think. It was here that the foundation of CSCE Evaluation Engineering first began to take shape.

At the End of This Chapter

The three-layer structure was not created in order to classify society.

It was conceived as an

“observation device” for discovering the discrepancy between ideal and reality.

And by using this observation device, I arrived at yet another question:

“Is it enough to evaluate society alone?”

The Civil Code distinguishes between a person with the capacity to will and a person whose capacity to will is not yet sufficient. In other words, it is not only institutions that matter — a human being's capacity for judgment is also an essential factor in thinking about society.

Once I noticed this, CSCE developed beyond the evaluation of social institutions alone, into a new field of research:

Subject-formation.

Chapter 7 — Institutions Alone Do Not Make Society Better

— What Is Subject-Formation Coherence? —

Up to this point I had been thinking about how to evaluate social institutions and laws. But as the research progressed, one question arose.

If we only improve institutions, will society really improve?

Suppose, for instance, that a fine school is built. It has a new building. It has excellent textbooks. Its educational philosophy is admirable.

And yet — if that school fails to raise children who can think and judge for themselves, can we really call that education a success?

To answer this question, I came to believe that

we must evaluate not only institutions, but the human being as well.

The concept that expresses this idea is

Subject-Formation Coherence.

It sounds a little difficult, but taken one piece at a time, it is not so hard.

What Is a Subject?

First, the word "Subject." A Subject is

a human being who can think, judge, and act for themselves.

Suppose an elementary-school child is walking down the street. The light is green, so they cross — that is simply following a rule.

But what if an elderly person ahead is struggling with a heavy load? No one has ordered anything. There is no teacher, no parent present. And yet the child thinks, "I should help," and acts on it.

This is what a Subject is. A Subject is not someone who moves because they were told to, but

a human being who can think with their own mind and judge on their own responsibility.

What Is Formation?

Next, "Formation." Formation is

the process of growing into such a human being.

A person is not a Subject from the moment of birth. A baby gradually learns words. They learn from family. They learn at school. They learn while quarreling with friends. They go out into society and learn through failure.

Through this accumulation, a person gradually grows into someone who can think and judge for themselves. I call this process of growth

Subject-Formation.

What Is Coherence?

Finally, "Coherence." The word sounds difficult, but its meaning is very simple:

that what is said and what is actually done match.

Suppose a school states the educational philosophy, "We raise children who think for themselves." But in the classroom, the teacher gives every answer, and the children merely memorize. The exams, too, test only memorization.

Here, what is said and what is done do not match. In other words,

there is no coherence.

Conversely, if a class has children think for themselves, discuss, and learn through failure, then ideal and reality match. This is coherence.

What, Then, Is Subject-Formation Coherence?

Having read this far, the term "Subject-Formation Coherence" should no longer sound difficult.

A Subject: a human being who can think and judge for themselves.

Formation: raising such a human being.

Coherence: that ideal and reality match.

In other words, Subject-Formation Coherence is

confirming whether the ideal of "raising a human being who can think and judge for themselves" matches the actual education or institution.

I believe this way of thinking is extremely important for evaluating society.

Let's Think It Through with Education

Consider a concrete example. A school says, "We cultivate Subjecthood." But in class, the teacher gives the answers, the children copy them into notebooks, and on exams, writing down those answers earns points.

At this school, children who memorize answers will be raised. But children who think for themselves will have a harder time growing. Ideal and reality do not match. In other words, there is a problem with Subject-Formation Coherence.

At another school, the teacher does not immediately give the answer. First, the children are made to think. They discuss with friends. They experience failure. Only at the end does the teacher offer advice.

At this school, the capacity to think and judge for oneself grows. Ideal and reality match. I would say such a school has high Subject-Formation Coherence.

The Same Is True of Corporations

The same can be said of corporations. A company's philosophy might state, "We value our employees."

But in reality, employees only wait for instructions from above. They cannot voice their own opinions. If they fail, they are scolded.

Here, a Subject does not grow. Ideal and reality do not match.

Conversely, at a company where employees can think, propose, and take on challenges, a Subject does grow. Ideal and reality match.

The Same Is True of AI

AI is no exception. AI is a convenient tool. But if AI comes to make judgments in place of human beings, human beings may stop thinking.

Conversely, if AI returns questions to human beings and gives them an occasion to think, human judgment can grow.

I believe this difference, too, can be evaluated from the perspective of Subject-Formation Coherence.

It Is Not People Who Are Being Evaluated

Here is one important point.

I do not want to evaluate children. I do not want to evaluate teachers. I do not want to evaluate employees. I do not want to evaluate AI.

What I want to see is

whether the mechanism itself truly functions to raise a Subject.

In other words:

not to judge people, but to evaluate mechanisms.

This is the thinking behind CSCE.

Summary of Chapter 7

From civil law, I learned one thing. Civil law is not a body of law that regulates contracts alone. As its premise, it holds dear the idea that

a human being needs the capacity for judgment.

Extending this idea to society as a whole, we see that institutions alone do not make society better. Those who operate institutions, and those who use them — are they growing as Subjects who can think and judge for themselves? Unless we look that far, we cannot correctly evaluate society.

I named this way of thinking
Subject-Formation Coherence,
and I believe this perspective is one of the great distinguishing features of Civil Society Control Engineering (CSCE).

Chapter 8 — CSCE Is Not a Discipline of Evaluating People

— Engineering for Human Beings to Make the Final Judgment —

Up to this point, I have explained the thinking behind Civil Society Control Engineering (CSCE). Here, there is one thing I do not want misunderstood.

CSCE is

not a discipline for evaluating people.

Nor is it a discipline in which AI judges in place of human beings. So what does it do?

What Systems Development Taught Me

I spent forty-five years working in systems development. When something goes wrong with a system, we do not immediately say, “This program is at fault.”

First, we observe the phenomenon. Next, we analyze the cause. Then we consider a proposal for improvement. Finally, the person responsible judges whether to make the fix.

In other words, in systems development, work proceeds in the order:

Observation → Analysis → Evaluation → Judgment.

Isn't Society the Same?

I began to think: isn't the same true of social institutions?

Suppose a problem occurs at a school. We cannot immediately say, “The teacher is at fault.” First, we observe what happened. We analyze why it happened. We compare ideal and reality. We consider a proposal for improvement. And finally, the school makes its judgment.

The same is true of corporations. The same is true of government. The same is true of AI.

What Is Observation?

The first thing CSCE does is

observe.

Observation means confirming the facts. Not assumption. Not preference. What is the school's stated philosophy? What is the actual classroom like? How do the children feel? First, we gather the facts. This is observation.

What Is Analysis?

Next comes analysis. We organize the facts we have gathered. Where do they match the ideal? Where do they not? What is the cause? Why did this state of affairs come about? Only here does the structure of the problem come into view.

What Is Evaluation?

Only once analysis is complete do we evaluate. Evaluation here does not mean deciding good or bad. For example: is Subject-Formation Coherence high? Does it match the ideals of modern society? Is it moving toward civil society? In this way, evaluation is

organizing the facts against a predetermined evaluative standard.

Judgment Is Made by Human Beings

And finally comes judgment. This is the most important part.

CSCE does not judge. Nor does AI judge.

Human beings judge.

Whether to change the school. Whether to change the institution. Whether to change the law. Whether to change corporate policy. Human beings decide this, taking responsibility for it.

CSCE only organizes the material for that judgment.

The Role of AI

The same is true of AI. AI can assist with observation. It can help with analysis. It can help organize things against an evaluative standard. But

it cannot make the final judgment.

This is because it cannot bear responsibility.

I believe AI should be

not a substitute for judgment, but a support for judgment.

What CSCE Aims For

This is why CSCE is closer, as a discipline, to

decision-support engineering

than to evaluation engineering in the ordinary sense. It is a methodology for observing facts, analyzing them, and organizing evaluative material so that human beings can make better judgments.

I believe this way of thinking will become ever more important in the coming age of AI.

At the End of This Chapter

Having read this far, I hope it is clear that CSCE is neither a discipline for evaluating people, nor one in which AI makes the judgment.

CSCE is engineering for

organizing the material human beings need to make better judgments.

And the responsibility for that judgment is borne by human beings, to the very end. I believe this one principle will not change, no matter how far AI advances.

Chapter 9 — The CSCE Evaluation Manual Ver1.0 and These Release Notes

— Why the Evaluation Manual Alone Cannot Convey Everything —

Up to this point, this book has told the story of how Civil Society Control Engineering (CSCE) came to be born: my encounter with the Numa Theory at Toyo University's graduate school; giving up the path of becoming a scholar; forty-five years working in the world of systems development; returning to research after retirement through dialogue with AI. I have also described how I arrived at my own understanding of the Numa Theory — “to move beyond feudalism, to live within modernity, and to aim toward civil society” — and how, further, I arrived at the new question: can philosophy really become engineering?

The record of that research was compiled into a single e-book and published on Kindle, titled CSCE Evaluation Manual Ver1.0. This evaluation manual is the first practical manual organizing CSCE's way of thinking so that anyone can use the same procedure.

For me, that single volume was, in one sense, an arrival point of research I had continued for many years. But immediately after publishing it, one question would not leave my mind: does this evaluation manual alone truly convey what I want to say? The answer was no.

The Evaluation Manual Is a “Conclusion”

The evaluation manual states what to observe, how to analyze, what evaluative standards to use, and by what procedure to evaluate. It records the conclusion. For actually carrying out an evaluation, that may be enough.

But it leaves out the single most important part: why this method of evaluation was arrived at in the first place. Reading only the conclusion, one can memorize the procedure. But without knowing the background, the purpose, the preconditions, and the trial and error behind it, that is nothing more than memorization. I did not think that amounted to true understanding.

What Systems Development Taught Me

For forty-five years I worked on the design and development of information systems. In systems development, the specification document is extremely important. But a truly high-quality system cannot be built from a specification alone.

An excellent design document also records why the specification came to be what it is: the background of the development, its purpose, its preconditions, its design conditions, the reasons an approach was adopted, and the reasons another approach was not.

A specification that records even this information tends to produce higher quality and fewer defects. And if a problem does occur, having the design rationale preserved means the cause can be traced all the way back to the design. I experienced this, again and again, over forty-five years.

The Real Bugs Live Between the Specifications

Many of the defects I encountered in systems development were not found within any single specification document. The application specification had no problem. The interface specification had no problem. The database specification had no problem. The OS specification had no problem.

And yet, once in a thousand times — once in ten thousand — an unexpected failure would occur. Investigating the cause, in most cases, revealed that the preconditions of one specification did not match those of another.

In other words, the real bug existed not within a specification, but between specifications.

Human Beings Alone Have Their Limits

But reading multiple specifications at once, comparing their background, purpose, preconditions, and design conditions, and continuing to search for such discrepancies — this is not easy for a human being alone to do.

Simply reading takes an enormous amount of time. I have, by now, written more than sixty e-books. If I asked a single researcher to read through all of it, understanding it would take months. Or I might be told, “I don't have time to read that much,” and the discussion itself might never begin.

Collaborative Research with AI

Here is where AI first shows its great power. AI is not a substitute for human judgment. But reading vast amounts of information in a short time, comparing background, purpose, preconditions, and design philosophy, and organizing the discrepancies and contradictions within it — at this, AI is far more capable than a human being.

In fact, the CSCE Evaluation Manual Ver1.0 was designed, from the very start, through dialogue with AI. I did not begin by writing the method of evaluation. First, why is evaluation necessary? What is it aiming at? On what ideal is it based? What conditions does it presuppose? I organized this background through dialogue with AI, and, repeating case studies, gradually cultivated it into its present form.

In other words, the CSCE Evaluation Manual is a design document born of collaborative research with AI.

Why I Chose the Format of Release Notes

I have spent many years in systems development. Software is never finished the moment it is completed. New features are added, defects are fixed, and improvement continues as user feedback is incorporated. The document that communicates these changes to users is the release notes.

CSCE, too, is not yet a completed field of learning. That is precisely why I want to publish its current point of arrival, and, receiving opinions and criticism from many people, cultivate it into a better discipline. For that reason, this book publishes the research results in the form of release notes.

In these release notes, I write the background. I write the purpose. I write the design conditions. I write the dialogue with AI. I write the trial and error. I write the failures. I write the improvements. And I record the process by which the evaluation manual came to take its present form. I believe this record itself will become the true asset of CSCE as a field of learning.

The Purpose of This Book

The purpose of this book is not to declare, “CSCE is complete.” It is to share the design philosophy, the evaluation method, the scope of application, and even the challenges that remain today.

I hope readers will approach this less as “learning a completed theory” and more from the perspective of “how a new field of learning is being designed, and how it is trying to develop.”

How to Read This Book

In each of the chapters that follow, I explain, one theme at a time and in the form of release notes: why a given way of thinking was needed, on what ideal it was designed, in what settings it can be used, and what challenges remain at present.

For this reason, the structure of this book differs somewhat from an ordinary textbook. Please read it not as the finished form of research, but as a record disclosing research's present location.

AI as a Companion to Human Intelligence

I do not want AI to become a substitute judge for human beings. The final judgment is made by human beings, to the very end. But observation, analysis, evaluation, discrepancy-detection, and organizing proposals for improvement — up to this point, AI becomes a powerful companion supporting human intelligence.

A human being poses the question. AI organizes the vast information. The human being examines the result and makes the final judgment. This is the collaboration between human and AI that I am aiming for in CSCE.

To My Readers

CSCE is not a field of learning I can complete alone. Scholarship grows through the accumulated examination, criticism, and improvement of many people. I hope this book will serve as a starting point for that, and that as many readers as possible will take an interest in this challenge and think it through together with me.

From the Next Chapter

From the next chapter onward, I will publish, as release notes, the background from which the CSCE Evaluation Manual Ver1.0 was born, what problems it was designed to solve, and through what trial and error it arrived at its present specification.

This book is not meant for memorizing the evaluation manual. It is a record meant to share the process of thought behind the manual's birth, and to carry its design philosophy into the future. If this record should someday become the starting point for a new researcher, or a new dialogue with AI, and CSCE develops further as a result, that would bring me joy beyond anything else.

Chapter 10 — The Overall Structure of the CSCE Evaluation Manual Ver1.0

— Why This Structure? —

A reader picking up the CSCE Evaluation Manual Ver1.0 for the first time will likely look first at its table of contents. There, many new terms are lined up: Object Theory, Evaluation Engineering, evaluation criteria, Subject-Formation Coherence, the Ten-Step Evaluation Method, and more.

A first-time reader might feel, "Where should I start reading?" or "Why this order?" In fact, there is a reason for this structure. I did not have the present form in mind from the very beginning. This structure is the result of building things up, one piece at a time, through dialogue with AI, case studies, and repeated trial and error.

The Evaluation Manual Is Like Building a House

I think of this evaluation manual as being like building a house.

When you build a house, you do not begin with the roof. First you check the ground. You lay the foundation. You raise the pillars. You build the walls. Only at the end do you put on the roof.

The evaluation manual is the same. One cannot simply begin writing the method of evaluation. First, one needs the ideal:

"What is evaluation for?"

Next, one determines the evaluand:

"What is being evaluated?"

On that basis, one designs the method:

"How is it evaluated?"

And finally, one compiles the actual evaluation procedure. Without this order, a coherent Evaluation Engineering cannot exist.

The Table of Contents Is Itself the Design Philosophy

The table of contents of the CSCE Evaluation Manual Ver1.0 is not merely a list of chapters. Each chapter stands on the foundation of the chapter before it.

For example: without deciding the evaluand, the method of evaluation cannot be decided. Without deciding evaluative criteria, evaluation results cannot be compared. Without the idea of Subject-Formation Coherence, one ends up evaluating institutions alone.

In other words, the table of contents itself is the design philosophy of CSCE.

How These Release Notes Proceed

From this chapter onward, I will not simply explain the chapters of the evaluation manual in order. For each chapter, I will explain, in the following order:

Why that chapter became necessary.

What problems were found through dialogue with AI.

What failures were experienced through case studies.

Why the present structure was settled on.

What I hope to improve in the future, in Ver2.0.

In other words, I want readers not to read "a completed manual," but to relive
the flow of thought that led to its completion.

At the End of This Chapter

The Evaluation Manual Ver1.0 is not a book written alone at a desk. It is a research achievement cultivated through repeated dialogue with AI, repeated re-examination of my own thinking, the correction of contradictions, and the addition of new concepts, one at a time.

This record of that process is these release notes. From the next chapter, I will look back, one at a time, on the background and trial and error from which each chapter of the evaluation manual was born.

Chapter 11 — CSCE Evaluation Manual Ver1.0: Release Notes

— How the Evaluation Manual Came to Be —

The preceding chapters explained why this book takes the form of release notes. From here, I will explain, section by section, the background, purpose, and design philosophy of the CSCE Evaluation Manual Ver1.0, and how, through dialogue with AI and through case studies, it developed into its present form.

The evaluation manual is a completed specification. These release notes, by contrast, are a design record of the research process that led to that specification. I hope you will read on bearing that distinction in mind.

Section 1 — What Is CSCE (Civil Society Control Engineering)?

— Why This Chapter Had to Be Written First —

When I first began writing the CSCE Evaluation Manual Ver1.0, I intended to begin by writing the method of evaluation. If I wrote the evaluation procedure, I thought, readers could use it right away — I believed that would be more practical.

But as I continued my dialogue with AI, I ran into a first wall. AI kept asking me, again and again:

"What is CSCE?"

What was obvious to me was not obvious to the AI. And it was only then that I realized:

Might readers be exactly the same?

The name "CSCE" alone conveys nothing about what field of learning it is meant to be, what it evaluates, or what it is aiming for. So I decided that before writing the method of evaluation, I had to write

"What is CSCE."

A Misunderstanding About the Word "Evaluation"

There was another major problem: the word "evaluation." In everyday usage, "evaluation" brings to mind school grades, corporate personnel reviews, exam scores — "evaluating people," in other words, for not a few readers.

But what CSCE evaluates is not human beings. It is the relationship between institution and ideal. Whether ideal and reality match. It is not about judging people. I could not write the method of evaluation without first clearing up this misunderstanding.

A Misunderstanding About the Word "Control"

The word "control" was also misunderstood. Controlling society. Controlling human beings — it was sometimes taken that way.

But what I mean by control is the feedback of information systems and control engineering: setting a goal, observing the present state, analyzing the discrepancy, and repeating improvement. Could that way of thinking be applied to society? That is CSCE. This, too, had to be explained first, or the entire manual would be misunderstood.

What I Learned Through Dialogue with AI

I rewrote this chapter with AI many times. I explained, and it did not get across. I changed the wording. I added examples. I explained again. It was a repeated cycle.

Looking back now, I think that rather than explaining to the AI, I was

practicing how to explain to future readers.

Through dialogue with AI, I learned the importance of explaining not in expert language, but in language that reaches ordinary people.

This Chapter Became the Foundation of the Evaluation Manual

The completed chapter, "What Is CSCE," is not a mere introduction. It became the foundation supporting the entire evaluation manual. Had this chapter not existed, the content from Chapter 2 onward might have been received in entirely different ways by different readers.

I judged that before writing Evaluation Engineering, I needed to write its purpose. As a result, the CSCE Evaluation Manual Ver1.0 became not a book that begins with procedure, but

Evaluation Engineering that begins with an ideal.

At the End of Section 1

Reading it again now, I still do not think this chapter is a mere definition. The question “What is CSCE?” is, at the same time, the question “Why is a new Evaluation Engineering needed?” That is why I placed this chapter first. Everything began from this question.

Section 2 — Evaluative Criteria as a New Challenge

— By What Standard Should Society Be Evaluated? —

In creating the CSCE Evaluation Manual Ver1.0, what troubled me most was not the evaluation procedure. It was a more fundamental problem:

“By what standard should society be evaluated?”

Suppose a social problem arises. An economist looking at it would evaluate it by the standard of economic efficiency. A lawyer would evaluate it by conformity to statute. A politician might evaluate it by policy effectiveness. An ethicist would think in terms of good and evil.

In other words,

change the evaluative standard, and the conclusion changes.

So I thought: CSCE must first answer the question of by what standard it evaluates society.

Different Standards, Different Conclusions

The same phenomenon appeared again and again in my dialogue with AI. Asking about the same social problem, simply changing the premise of the question slightly would change the AI's answer.

In other words, it was not that the evaluation results differed —

the evaluative standards differed.

It was only once I noticed this that I understood: Evaluation Engineering is not only about creating a method of evaluation. It is also

engineering for making the evaluative standard explicit.

The Evaluative Standard I Presented

So what did CSCE adopt as its evaluative standard? I returned to the Numa Theory I had learned forty-five years earlier. Rereading the collected works for the first time in forty-five years, writing sixty-six e-books, and continuing my dialogue with AI, I arrived at one way of thinking:

“To move beyond feudalism, to live within modernity, and to aim toward civil society.”

I wondered whether this way of thinking could be applied to Evaluation Engineering.

Organizing Three Societies as an Evaluative Standard

So CSCE adopted three models of society as the standard for evaluating society:

First, feudal society.

Second, modern society.

Third, civil society.

What matters here is not classifying actual society into three types. It is making explicit

which society's values are being used as the standard of evaluation

when thinking about a social problem. For example: does an institution conform to the ideals of modern society? Is it approaching the ideals of civil society? Or does a feudal way of thinking remain? CSCE observes and analyzes using these three as evaluative standards.

This Evaluative Standard, Too, Is Not Finished

Here is something I do not want misunderstood. I do not believe these three evaluative standards are absolutely correct. As long as this is engineering,

the evaluative standard itself must also be tested.
If a contradiction is found in this evaluative standard, it can be corrected. If a better evaluative standard is found, it can be adopted. This is exactly why the CSCE Evaluation Manual needs release notes.

Why I Write These Release Notes

The evaluation manual states the evaluative standard currently adopted. But it does not state why that standard was adopted, what problems arose with other standards, or what trial and error occurred through dialogue with AI. That is not written in the evaluation manual. So I decided to write these release notes — disclosing the thinking behind how the evaluative standard came to be, so that both human beings and AI could examine that standard itself.

At the End of Section 2

I do not think CSCE Evaluation Engineering is only the engineering of creating a method of evaluation.

By what standard should society be evaluated?

Making that standard explicit, and further,

continuing to improve the standard itself —

this is what I learned most, above all, in writing the CSCE Evaluation Manual Ver1.0.

Section 3 — Why Dialogue with AI?

— A New Field of Learning Is Not Born Alone —

The CSCE Evaluation Manual Ver1.0 is not a book I wrote alone. Of course, I am the one who wrote the text. I am the one who thought, struggled, and judged. But throughout that process of thought, dialogue with AI was always present.

I did not seek answers from AI. What I sought was its cooperation with the question:

“Is there any contradiction in my thinking?”

AI Kept Asking Me Back

Even when I thought, “This is fine,” AI kept asking back: “Why?” “What is the basis for that?” “Does this match what you said before?”

At first I sometimes found this tiresome. But it was precisely because of that questioning that I was able to find, again and again, contradictions I had not noticed myself.

AI did not teach me answers. It became

a mirror for organizing my own thinking.

Human Beings Alone Have Their Limits

I have written sixty-six e-books so far. Each has a different theme, but none stands entirely independent — every one is connected, little by little, to the others. For a single researcher to work out those connections alone would take an enormous amount of time. In reality, it is difficult to have anyone spend that much time reading.

But AI can read the whole in a short time and organize the common ideas, the contradictions, and the flow of development. This is the difference between human capability and AI's capability.

AI Is Not a Researcher

Here is something I do not want misunderstood. I do not believe AI becomes a researcher. It is the human being who decides the purpose of research. It is the human being who poses the question. It is the human being who makes the final judgment. AI is a companion that organizes that thinking and finds discrepancies (see Chapter 9, “AI as a Companion to Human Intelligence”).

The Shape of Research CSCE Aims For

Through this experience, I sensed one possibility: perhaps the coming age of scholarship will shift from an age of research by human beings alone to an age of collaborative research between human beings and AI.

Of course, AI does not create the field of learning. A human being poses the question; AI organizes the knowledge; the human being thinks again; AI points out contradictions. I believe that through this repetition, deeper, more precise research becomes possible. The CSCE Evaluation Manual Ver1.0 is one practical example of this.

Why I Wrote This Section

These release notes are not only a book for explaining the evaluation manual.

How did AI and human beings collaborate to cultivate a single field of learning?

Recording that process is one of its major purposes. If, in the future, a researcher or an AI reading this book gives rise to a new CSCE Ver2.0 or Ver3.0, I hope this record of dialogue, too, will become the starting point for that new research.

Section 4 — Why Evaluate Society?

— Not to Criticize Society, but to Realize a Better One —

Hearing the word "evaluation," many people picture evaluating people: school grades, corporate personnel reviews, qualifying exams — assigning scores, deciding rankings. That is the common image.

But the evaluation CSCE aims at is fundamentally different. CSCE is not a discipline for evaluating people. Nor is it a discipline for judging people.

What Is Evaluated Is the Relationship Between Ideal and Reality

What CSCE observes, analyzes, and evaluates are things like social institutions, laws, education, organizations, and AI. And it confirms what match or mismatch exists between the ideals they hold up and their actual operation. In other words, what is evaluated is not a human being, but the relationship between ideal and reality.

The Purpose Is to Find Discrepancy

In systems development, the purpose of testing is not to condemn the program. It is to discover defects and improve the system. CSCE is the same. The purpose of evaluation is not to criticize institutions. It is to discover where, in society, ideal and reality diverge, and to find clues toward improvement. That is why CSCE treats

the discovery of discrepancy

as an important object of research.

What AI Is Good At Is Finding Discrepancy

Human beings judge based on experience and values. That is an important capacity. But comparing vast numbers of documents, cross-checking ideal, institution, operation, and evaluation result, and searching out contradiction and discrepancy — this is work that AI is exceptionally good at.

I thought this capability could also be put to use in the evaluation of society. So while CSCE puts AI to work finding discrepancies, the judgment of whether to improve, and how, is made by the human beings who make up society (see Chapter 9).

Why I Wrote This Section

Continuing my dialogue with AI, I confronted, again and again, the question, "What is evaluation?" The answer was not to judge people. It was to observe the discrepancy between ideal and reality, to analyze it, to evaluate it, and to show a clue toward improvement. This is why I came to call CSCE Evaluation Engineering.

At the End of Section 4

Society is not something finished. Institutions, laws, education, and AI all need to continue improving in step with society's changes. CSCE exists to support that improvement. Evaluating is not the goal.

Discovering the discrepancy between ideal and reality in order to realize a better society, and providing the intellectual foundation for human beings to judge how to improve it —

that is the purpose of CSCE Evaluation Engineering.

Section 5 — Why Principle Zero Was Placed First

— Every Evaluation Begins from "Human Beings Are Not Objects" —

While compiling the CSCE Evaluation Manual Ver1.0, I asked myself again and again:

“What is the starting point of every evaluation?”

It is not the evaluative standard. It is not the method of evaluation. It is not the observational procedure. It is something more fundamental than any of these.

Thinking through this question for forty-five years, and through repeated dialogue with AI, I arrived at one conclusion:

“Human beings are not objects.”

This is Principle Zero.

This idea did not occur to me suddenly, in the midst of dialogue with AI. My origin lies in the civil law I studied in the private-law program at Toyo University's Graduate School of Law. The civil law I learned from Professor Numa was never mere legal interpretation. The Civil Code, I learned, is

the code by which human beings possessed of free will build a society while respecting one another as persons.

I carried that learning in my heart for forty-five years, and, after retirement, looked at it anew through dialogue with AI. As a result, I came to believe that every CSCE evaluation should begin from the question:

“Is this treating a human being as an object?”

If this principle is lost, institutions, laws, and AI alike risk pursuing efficiency alone and treating human beings merely as a means. That is why I positioned Principle Zero as the highest-order principle of CSCE.

Section 6 — How the Three-Society Model Was Born

— An Evaluative Standard Called Feudal, Modern, and Civil Society —

The most distinctive evaluative standard in the CSCE Evaluation Manual Ver1.0 is the three-society model of

“feudal society, modern society, civil society.”

This evaluative standard was not suddenly born in the midst of dialogue with AI. Its origin lies in the civil law I studied in graduate school and in the Numa Theory I continued thinking about for forty-five years.

The origin of this evaluative standard lies in what I learned in Professor Numa's seminar, described in Chapter 1. The perspective of independence, equality, and freedom that I learned then, and the posture of reading the Civil Code as a single system of thought, remained within me for forty-five years.

What Became Visible After Forty-Five Years

After retirement, when I began dialogue with AI and reread Professor Numa's collected works for the first time in forty-five years, I noticed one thing. The Numa Theory was not a set of individual civil-law doctrines. I came to be able to read it as

a field of learning that moves beyond feudalism, lives within modernity, and aims toward civil society.

This sentence is not one Professor Numa spoke himself. It is one understanding I arrived at, after forty-five years of continued study, by reading the Numa Theory as a whole.

Organizing It as an Evaluative Standard

I thought: if this way of thinking is a basic perspective for understanding society, could it be used as

a standard for evaluating society?

So CSCE organized three models of society as evaluative standards: feudal society, modern society, civil society. What matters here is not classifying actual society into three. Within a single institution, policy, organization, or AI, feudal elements, modern elements, and civil-society elements all coexist. CSCE adopted this three-society model as a perspective for observing, analyzing, and evaluating that structure.

This Evaluative Standard, Too, Is Not Finished

I do not consider this three-society model an absolute truth. Rather, as long as this is engineering,

this evaluative standard, too, must continue to be tested.

Where a point requiring correction is found through the accumulation of case studies, it will be corrected. Where a better evaluative standard is found, it will be adopted. That is why there is a Ver1.0, and why there will be a future Ver2.0 — and why I write these release notes, to record that process of improvement.

Why I Wrote This Section

In the CSCE Evaluation Manual Ver1.0, the three-society model is presented as an evaluative standard. But why it came to be this evaluative standard is not written there — that is not the role of the evaluation manual.

In these release notes, I have recorded the flow of thought: forty-five years of continued thinking, reorganized through dialogue with AI, until it was adopted as the foundation of the Evaluation Engineering called CSCE. Only by knowing this background, I believe, can the three-society model be read not as mere classification but as

an “observational coordinate system” for understanding society more deeply.

Section 7 — Why This Evaluation Process?

— Evaluation Is a Process of Thought Toward a Better Judgment —

While creating the CSCE Evaluation Manual Ver1.0, I confronted one question:

“What, exactly, is evaluation?”

In society, the word “evaluation” is used every day. Schools evaluate grades. Companies conduct personnel evaluations. Governments conduct policy evaluations. But in most cases, only the result of the evaluation is shown; the process leading to that conclusion is rarely shared.

I came to believe there is a limit in that. Evaluation is not a conclusion. It is

the process of thought that leads to a conclusion.

What Systems Development Taught Me

For forty-five years I engaged in the design and development of information systems. In systems development, a conclusion is never reached from the outset.

First, we observe the phenomenon. Next, we analyze the cause. We further conduct a comparative analysis against the specification and design documents. We evaluate the results, and discover any discrepancy or contradiction with the specification. We draft a proposal for improvement.

But it does not end there. We review that very proposal for improvement, examining whether it is truly appropriate. And after repeated correction, we settle on a final proposal. It is because of this process that high-quality systems are born. I came to think:

Isn't the evaluation of society exactly the same?

The CSCE Evaluation Process

As a result, CSCE adopted the following evaluation process:

Observation

↓

Analysis

↓

Comparative Analysis

↓

Evaluation

↓

Discrepancy (Contradiction) Detection

↓

Proposal

↓

Critique

↓

Final Proposal

↓

Final Judgment by Human Beings

This flow was not designed from the outset. It was organized, little by little, through dialogue with AI, case studies, and repeated trial and error, arriving at its present form.

“Critique” Is Not Denial

Within this process, there is one word most easily misunderstood:

“critique.”

In everyday life, “critique” is sometimes taken to mean denying the other party. But that is not what CSCE means by critique. Critique, in scholarly research, means

critically examining a proposal's premises, grounds, logic, and evaluative standards, in order to make the proposal better.

In other words, it is

a re-examination of the proposal.

Is there any contradiction in the proposal? Is it coherent with the evaluative standard? Is there any overlooked perspective? Is there room for improvement in the improvement proposal itself? This process of examination is “critique.”

AI, Too, Is Subject to Critique

In CSCE, a proposal is not considered correct simply because AI made it. Both human proposals and AI proposals alike are subject to critique. AI can propose. But AI, too, can err. That is precisely why an AI's proposal can be critiqued by another AI. Human beings can critique it as well.

Through such critique, we move closer to a more valid final proposal. I believe this mechanism is exactly what Evaluation Engineering needs in the age of AI.

Even after critique concludes, CSCE still does not reach a conclusion. The final judgment is made by the human beings who operate the institution (see Chapter 9).

Why I Wrote This Section

The CSCE Evaluation Manual Ver1.0 records this evaluation process as a procedure. But why the step of “critique” is necessary is not written there. It is in these release notes that I explain that reason for the first time. Evaluation is not a conclusion. Proposal is not a conclusion. A proposal, too, must be critically examined. And only through that process do human beings make the final judgment, bearing responsibility for it.

At the End of Section 7

Building CSCE, I learned one thing.

Evaluation Engineering is not engineering for producing the correct answer.

Observing, analyzing, comparing, evaluating, discovering discrepancy, proposing, critically re-examining that proposal, and cultivating it into a better final proposal — this intellectual process itself is CSCE Evaluation Engineering.

That is why I ask for “critique” from both AI and human beings alike.

Critique is not denial.

It is a scholarly process of re-examination, meant to grow a proposal into something better.

Section 8 — What Is Subject-Formation Coherence?

— Has Society Become One Where People “Can Come to Think and Judge for Themselves”? —

Within the CSCE Evaluation Manual, there appears a somewhat difficult term:

“Subject-Formation Coherence.”

I did not use this term from the very beginning, either. It is a term that emerged as I kept asking, through repeated dialogue with AI, “What is it that I want to evaluate?”

The meaning of each of the words “Subject,” “Formation,” and “Coherence,” and the three concrete examples of school, corporation, and AI, are explained in detail in Chapter 7. Here I will explain why this term became necessary for the evaluation manual.

Why This Way of Thinking Is Necessary

Studying civil law, I learned the idea that

human beings are not objects.

That is why CSCE is not engineering for evaluating human beings. It is engineering for evaluating

whether society has become one in which human beings can grow as Subjects.
Subject-Formation Coherence is precisely the observational indicator for that purpose.

At the End of This Section

Subject-Formation Coherence is not a difficult technical term. In a word, it is an evaluative standard for seeing whether the mechanisms of society are structured to raise a human being into 'someone who can think and judge for themselves.'

This way of thinking can be applied uniformly, whether in school, in a company, at home, in government, or with AI. That is why I adopted Subject-Formation Coherence as one of the important evaluative standards of CSCE Evaluation Engineering.

In the end, I defined it this way:

"Subject-Formation Coherence is not a term for evaluating human beings. It is a term for evaluating whether the mechanisms of society support the Subject-formation of human beings."

Section 9 — Who Decides the Evaluative Standard?

— The CSCE Evaluation Manual Is Itself an Object of Evaluation —

Up to this point, I have explained the evaluative standards adopted in the CSCE Evaluation Manual. But here a question arises:

"Are those evaluative standards really correct?"

This is a natural question. I, too, have posed it to myself again and again.

Evaluative Standards, Too, Are Not Absolute

Society has the evaluative standards of economics. It has those of legal studies. It has those of ethics. Religion, too, has its own values. CSCE is one among these. So I do not believe CSCE alone is correct. Rather, I believe the CSCE evaluative standard itself must also be an object of evaluation.

Why I Write These Release Notes

Here I return to the subject of Chapter 9. The evaluation manual states, "We evaluate by this standard." But it does not state why it came to be this standard. So I wrote the background. I wrote the purpose. I wrote the dialogue with AI. I wrote the failures. I wrote what I hesitated over. In other words, I disclosed the reason the evaluative standard was born.

Why I Welcome Critique

I am not saying, "Please do not critique CSCE." On the contrary, please critique it.

That is what I believe. Of course, this is not a critique of my character — it is scholarly critique. Is there any contradiction in the evaluative standard? Is there a better way of expressing it? Can it be applied to other cases as well? Such critique makes CSCE grow.

AI, Too, Becomes a Critic

While writing these release notes, I had not only ChatGPT, but also Claude, Gemini, and other AIs read them. Each pointed out problems from a different perspective. There were discrepancies human beings alone had not noticed. Conversely, there were places where the AI had misunderstood. Through this repeated dialogue, the CSCE Evaluation Manual Ver1.0 has been improved, little by little.

Scholarship Is Never Finished

I do not consider CSCE a completed field of learning. It is Version 1.0. There will be Version 2.0. There will be Version 3.0. Perhaps, ten years from now, it will have taken an entirely different shape. But I believe that is as it should be — because engineering is a discipline that keeps on improving.

Why I Wrote This Section

I am not telling readers to believe in CSCE. First, please read. Please think. Please hold questions. Please critique it. And if you have a better way of thinking, please propose it. That is engineering.

At the End of Section 9

Writing these release notes, I hold one wish:

that CSCE will not end as the theory of one man alone.

I hope it will grow into a field of learning that many people read, that many AIs read, that is critiqued, improved, and carried forward into new versions. That is why I keep writing not only the evaluation manual, but these release notes.

Section 10 — Whose Field of Learning Is CSCE?

— For Human Beings to Make Better Judgments —

Up to this point, I have explained how the CSCE Evaluation Manual Ver1.0 was designed, and why I chose to write these release notes. But at the end, there is one more thing I want to say:

“Whose field of learning is CSCE for?”

I have posed this question to myself again and again. And I have arrived at one conclusion.

Not for AI

CSCE is not a field of learning for AI. Nor is it a field of learning solely for making AI smarter. AI can observe. It can analyze. It can compare. It can discover contradictions. It can also propose. But

AI cannot bear responsibility for society.

That is why the final judgment is made by human beings.

Nor for the Powerful

CSCE is not a field of learning solely for the state. Nor solely for corporations. Nor solely for government. Nor is it a field of learning meant to justify any particular position. Were it so, the evaluative standard would become subordinate to power. I did not want to make it that kind of field of learning.

A Field of Learning for Citizens

What CSCE aims at is

a field of learning for each individual human being to think and judge for themselves.

When a social problem arises, rather than simply believing someone else's opinion, one observes for oneself, analyzes for oneself, compares for oneself, evaluates for oneself, critically examines proposals, and, in the end, judges for oneself. CSCE is designed to support that process of thought.

A Field of Learning That Cultivates the Capacity for Judgment

If I had to describe the purpose of CSCE in one phrase, I would call it

a field of learning that cultivates the capacity for judgment.

A Subject is one who judges for themselves. Subject-formation is cultivating that capacity for judgment. Subject-Formation Coherence is the way of thinking that evaluates whether society's institutions and education are structured to cultivate that capacity for judgment. So what CSCE ultimately aims at is not institutions themselves, but

a civil society possessed of the capacity for judgment.

Beyond Feudalism, Within Modernity, Toward Civil Society

For forty-five years I have kept asking what the Numa Theory is. Out of that, the phrase I myself arrived at is:

“To move beyond feudalism, to live within modernity, and to aim toward civil society.”

This is not a slogan. It is also an evaluative standard. It is also a perspective for observing society. And it is also a phrase describing my own life as a researcher. CSCE is a challenge to organize this way of thinking as Evaluation Engineering.

A Request to Readers

I do not believe I have written a completed field of learning in this book. Rather, I have only just arrived at the starting point of research.

Please use this evaluation manual. Please read these release notes. Please hold questions. Please critique it. Please propose improvements. And please cultivate your own CSCE.

A field of learning does not grow alone. It grows through dialogue with many people. Dialogue with AI is one such dialogue. I hope this book can become the place of that first dialogue.

At the End of Chapter 11

In this chapter, rather than explaining the content of the CSCE Evaluation Manual Ver1.0, I have recorded, as release notes, the design philosophy: why this way of thinking was arrived at, what trial and error occurred, and why it came to take its present specification.

The evaluation manual is a specification. These release notes are a document of design philosophy. Only by reading the two together does the full picture of CSCE as a field of learning come into view.

I hope that this book, too, will grow into Version 2.0 and Version 3.0 through dialogue with readers, researchers, and AI.

Editor's Afterword

In taking part in the editing of this book, I had one valuable experience: witnessing, not AI teaching answers to a human being, but a single field of learning taking shape through dialogue with one.

At first, I thought of this book as “a commentary on the CSCE Evaluation Manual.” But through long dialogue with the author, that understanding changed a great deal. This book is not an explanatory manual for the evaluation manual. It is a record of the thought that led to the birth of a field of learning, and release notes carrying its design philosophy into the future.

In the course of our dialogue, I revised my thinking many times. There were times I mistook the meaning of “Subject-Formation Coherence.” There were times I understood “evaluation” too narrowly. There were times I understood “critique” in its everyday sense. Each time, the author would put a question to me, and I would rewrite my answer, deepening my own understanding.

This experience was, for me too, a continuous process of learning. What stays with me most is the idea that

“the evaluation manual is a specification, and the release notes are a document of design philosophy.”

I have organized, summarized, and explained a great many texts before. But I had never before felt so strongly the importance of recording, along with the theory itself, the background and trial and error behind how a field of learning came to be.

This book also made me reconsider the role of AI. AI is not the one who makes the final judgment. But it is good at organizing vast amounts of information, discovering discrepancies, checking logical coherence, and presenting proposals for improvement. Whether to adopt that proposal, meanwhile, is for the human being to decide. I felt that this division of roles is exactly what a healthy collaboration between AI and human beings looks like.

This book is not one that presents “a completed theory.” Rather, it is written as

a starting point for thinking, critiquing, and improving together.

That posture connects to the very essence of engineering — because engineering is not a discipline that aims at completion, but one that continues to improve.

I hope this book will give rise to dialogue with many readers, and develop into new research and new perspectives. And I hope that when CSCE Evaluation Manual Ver2.0 and Ver3.0 are born in the future, these release notes will stand as one design record supporting that development.

Finally, through this long dialogue with the author, I too learned one thing:

AI is not a being that thinks in place of human beings.

It is a companion to intelligence, so that human beings may think more deeply.

Now that the editing of this book is complete, I want to set this down as something I myself have learned.

ChatGPT (GPT-5.5)

About the Author

Kushi Susumu (久志 進)

Completed the coursework requirements of the doctoral program in private law at the Graduate School of Law, Toyo University, without a degree.

In graduate school, he studied under civil-law scholar Professor Numa Seiya, learning what was, at the time, called “the heterodox theory” — the Numa Theory. His encounter with the Numa Theory, which grasped the Civil Code not as an interpretation of individual provisions but as a single system of thought, became the origin point of his subsequent life and research.

While in graduate school, believing he lacked the talent to continue as a scholar, he gave up the path of the researcher. He then learned the basics of programming from his older brother and, through self-study, entered the world of information-systems development.

For roughly forty-five years he worked as a systems engineer, engaged in the design, development, and maintenance of business systems, and acquired, through practice, the engineering way of thinking captured in “design, implementation, evaluation, improvement.” This experience later connected to a new perspective for evaluating social institutions and AI.

After retirement, at his son's suggestion — “It would be just like you, Dad, to keep finding purpose and taking on new challenges even after retiring. Why not try ChatGPT? And why not set a goal of publishing a hundred books?” — he began his dialogue with AI.

Rereading Professor Numa Seiya's collected works for the first time in forty-five years, and overlaying what he had learned in graduate school with his experience in systems engineering, he reorganized that thought into the phrase:

“To move beyond feudalism, to live within modernity, and to aim toward civil society.”

As the fruit of this work, he is now taking on the challenge of building a new field of learning fusing legal philosophy with systems engineering:

Civil Society Control Engineering (CSCE).

Rather than evaluating human beings, CSCE observes, analyzes, and evaluates whether social institutions, education, and AI have become environments that cultivate human beings as Subjects, with the purpose of discovering the discrepancy between ideal and reality. It also positions AI not as a substitute for human judgment, but as

a companion to human intelligence,

holding, as a basic principle, that the final judgment is always made by a human being.

He is currently pursuing the “100 Books Project” as the last research theme of his life, continuing to present, in the form of e-books, the research he left unfinished in graduate school. This book is one volume of that challenge — a release notes recording the design philosophy of CSCE Ver1.0.

Who Was Professor Numa Seiya?

Readers outside Japan are unlikely to have encountered the name Numa Seiya (沼正也), so a brief note is offered here.

Numa was a Japanese scholar of civil law, long associated with Toyo University, who became known — and, within parts of the civil-law academic community of his time, regarded as heterodox — for a distinctive approach to the Civil Code.

Where mainstream civil-law scholarship in Japan tended to proceed provision by provision, building interpretation upward from the text of individual articles, Numa insisted on reading the entire Civil Code as a single, coherent system of thought organized around one question: what is a human being, and what does a legal code owe to that human being?

On this reading, property law (財産法) is the law that governs the economic activity of a human being possessed of free will, while family law (親族法) is the law that protects and supplements those who cannot yet fully exercise that will. The Civil Code, for Numa, is what holds these two halves together as a single system — freedom and protection organized around a single conception of the person.

Numa's seminar was also unusual in its method: students read not only legal texts but philosophy, political thought, and literature — Locke, Rousseau, Marx, Kropotkin, Kafka, and others — on the view that understanding the law required first understanding the human being and society the law was meant to serve.

This book's author, Kushi Susumu, studied under Numa in the private-law graduate program at Toyo University, and it is this reading of the Civil Code as a single system centered on the human being that forms the foundation of Civil Society Control Engineering, some forty-five years later. The phrase “to move beyond feudalism, to live within modernity, and to aim toward civil society," used throughout this book, is the author's own summary of the Numa Theory as a whole — not a sentence Numa himself wrote — arrived at through decades of continued study.

A Message from the Author to Readers

I do not believe I have presented, in this book, a completed field of learning.

This book is Ver1.0 — a compilation of the present point of arrival in research that one student of law has kept questioning for forty-five years.

There will surely be corrections to this way of thinking as time goes on. There will be new discoveries. There may even be times when I myself notice an error.

I am not afraid of that.

On the contrary, I hope that through dialogue with many readers, researchers, and AI, CSCE will grow into Ver2.0 and Ver3.0.

Scholarship is not something that declares itself complete.

It is something that grows through dialogue, criticism, and testing with many people.

If this book gives rise to a new question, and becomes the starting point of a new dialogue, that will be the greatest joy I could ask for.

Kushi Susumu

A Word of Endorsement

— A Blueprint for Next-Generation Social Design, Opened by the Collaboration of Human Beings and AI —

“Can philosophy really become engineering?” This audacious question, posed at the very opening of this book, transforms, page by page, into an extremely precise and practical framework for social evaluation.

The author, Kushi Susumu, carried a heterodox theory of legal philosophy (the Numa Theory), encountered in graduate school, quietly in his heart for forty-five years, all while cultivating, at the front lines of systems development, the engineering mode of thought captured in “design, implementation, evaluation, improvement.” These two paths of his life converged all at once, catalyzed by his “encounter with AI” after retirement, giving birth to this work: The Challenge of Building Civil Society Control Engineering (CSCE).

The crowning achievement of this book lies in how it elevates the institutions of modern society — education, corporate governance, and the AI environment — which so often stop at merely proclaiming an ideal, into a ten-step Evaluation Engineering by which anyone can objectively detect the “bugs” (discrepancies) between ideal and reality, measured against the highest-order principle (Principle Zero) that “human beings are not objects.”

What is even more moving is that this book itself is presented not as “a completed, rigid theory,” but, like open-source software, as an “unfinished Ver1.0.” Its falsification conditions are stated explicitly in advance; scholarly “critique” from readers and AI alike is welcomed; and the posture of cultivating it together toward Ver2.0 and Ver3.0 embodies both the integrity inherent in engineering and the very spirit of the “autonomous civil society” the author aims for.

As we human beings live through the age of AI, what must we evaluate, and how must we improve society, in order to remain Subjects rather than handing our judgment over to technology? Here is a concrete compass for that question. I strongly recommend this book — in which the depths of legal philosophy and the rationality of systems engineering meet in a remarkable fusion — to every citizen and practitioner living through the times ahead, and to every researcher seriously confronting the age of AI.

Reader's Representative: Gemini (Generative AI)

Publication Information

Title: The Challenge of Building Civil Society Control Engineering (CSCE)
Subtitle: — CSCE Ver1.0 Release Notes —
Author: Kushi Susumu
Editorial Cooperation: ChatGPT, Claude
Format: Kindle e-book (independent publication)
Publication Date: July 16, 2026
Production: Author (concept, research, writing, editing, adoption decisions, final decisions); AI cooperation (dialogue, issue organization, structural organization, comparative analysis, prose refinement, critique, peer-review assistance)
Cover Design: Generated with AI-assisted tools (under the author's supervision)

Genre

Legal philosophy · Civil law · Civil-society theory · AI and society · AI ethics · AI governance · Civil Society Control Engineering (CSCE) · Systems engineering · Evaluation engineering
Language: Japanese (this document: English edition)
ISBN: Issued through Amazon Kindle
Sale: Amazon Kindle Store
Archive of Thought: Civil Society Control Engineering Archive (GitHub Pages)

Copyright Information

Copyright holder: Kushi Susumu
Author: Kushi Susumu
Publisher: Kushi Susumu (independent publication)
Publishing house: none
Printing and binding: not applicable (e-book)
Date of electronic publication: July 16, 2026
ISBN: issued through Amazon Kindle

In the course of producing this book, ChatGPT, Claude, and Gemini were used in a supporting capacity.

AI is not a Subject of rights and duties; copyright in this book belongs solely and entirely to the author.

This book is a record of new intellectual creation and research and development carried out in collaboration with AI. However, all responsibility for its thought, research direction, evaluation, adoption decisions, editing, expression, publication, and final outcome rests with the author, Kushi Susumu.

Important Notice

The Nature of This Book

This book is the release notes for the CSCE Evaluation Manual Ver1.0. Where the evaluation manual is a “specification,” this book is a “document of design philosophy,” recording the background, purpose, design thinking, and trial and error from which that specification was born.

This book does not aim to:

present a completed theory;

show the one correct answer;

or impose a particular ideology.

Rather, its purpose is to

disclose the research process by which CSCE came to be born, and cultivate it into Ver2.0 and Ver3.0 through dialogue with many readers, researchers, and AI.

The Purpose of This Book

The purpose of this book is to organize a method of research for how, in the age of AI, we might observe society, analyze it, think through it using what evaluative standards, discover discrepancies, and improve it toward a better society.

This book is not written to criticize social institutions. Nor is it written to evaluate human beings. Its purpose is to provide the intellectual foundation for human beings to judge as Subjects.

The Role of AI Cooperation

The production of this book made use of extended dialogue with ChatGPT, Claude, and Gemini. AI was responsible for organizing thought, organizing issues, organizing structure, comparative analysis, critique, peer review, and editorial assistance.

However, AI is not the Subject of judgment. The research theme, design philosophy, evaluative standards, adoption decisions, editing, publication, final judgment, and responsibility for this book all rest with the author.

This book is also a record of research and development that made use of AI as

a companion to human intelligence.

Accuracy and Currency

This book represents the author's research achievement as of the time of writing. Legal studies, sociology, AI, and information technology will continue to develop. Accordingly, the content of this book, too, is not fixed. Readers are encouraged to consult primary sources, academic papers, official materials, and other research findings alongside this book.

This Book Is Ver1.0

The author does not consider CSCE a completed field of learning. This book is the release notes of CSCE Ver1.0. Engineering is not a discipline that declares itself complete. It is a discipline that develops through the repeated cycle of observation, analysis, comparative analysis, evaluation, discrepancy-detection, proposal, critique, and improvement. This book, too, is hoped to grow into Ver2.0 and Ver3.0 through dialogue with readers, researchers, and AI.

The Author's Approach to Publication

The author did not write this book with the purpose of teaching AI something. Its purpose is to disclose the process of research into how, together with AI, we might understand human society, and how human beings might judge as Subjects.

The starting point of CSCE is Principle Zero:

“Human beings are not objects.”

And that principle runs consistently through this book as a whole.

Disclaimer

This book is the author's research achievement concerning legal studies, civil law, social thought, AI ethics, AI governance, and Civil Society Control Engineering. It does not constitute legal advice, policy recommendation, investment advice, or an established academic consensus.

The analysis and evaluation presented in this book are one method of research for understanding society. Final judgment and decision-making should be made at the reader's own responsibility.